

FEAST OF ODOACER

BY J.C. CONNORS

ABOUT THE ADVENTURE

Feast of Odoacer is a *Call of Cthulhu: Cthulhu Invictus* adventure, although it can be easily translated to other systems (a *GURPS Horror* version is available on www.1shotadventures.com). The adventure is set in Ravenna in March, 493 A.D., just a few decades after the last Roman emperor abdicated his position, and Italy fell under the control of Odoacer, a patrician who desperately attempted to keep the remnants of the Empire intact. The adventure is suitable for four-to-six investigators appropriate to be high-level servants of King Odoacer; the end of the adventure includes six pregenerated characters.

Characters introduced for the first time in the adventure are noted in ALL-CAPS. Skill rolls are in SMALL-CAPS. Sections marked with a map icon are sidequests and adventure hooks, and not important to the overall plot of the adventure. Sections marked with a person icon are opportunities for specific types of investigators, especially the pregenerated characters from this adventure.

ADVENTURE SUMMARY

By 493 A.D., the Roman Empire had collapsed. KING FLAVIUS ODOACER (pronounced ô-dô-ôker) rules the remnants of Italy. Once blessed by ZENO, the Emperor of the eastern empire, Odoacer is now considered a rival. Determined to remove Odoacer from power, Emperor Zeno has promised Italy to a young Ostrogoth warlord, THEODORIC. After seven years of war and many grievous defeats, Odoacer has finally holed himself up in the walled, capital city of Ravenna, desperate to cling on to power and survive the long siege.

The investigators are members of Odoacer's court. They have served him willingly and honorably for

years, even as he has grown more wretched. Knowing that the situation is worsening by the day, Odoacer sends them to find SEVERINUS, a mysterious monk who has written him increasingly-frenzied letters insisting he has found something that can help Odoacer resist Theodoric's conquest. Severinus, however, has gone mad after witnessing cultists, the Disciples of Teritus, experimenting on an unnatural, abyssal carcass. The monk believes that the Disciples have found a relic that can stop Theodoric, and pleads with the investigators to bring the cult's secrets to the king.

The Disciples, however, have their own plans. Sick of corrupt kings and constant instability, they seek to use their ancient ritual to put the entire city under the sway of Teritus, a daemonic outer force, who they believe is the incarnation of a forgotten, pagan god. They mistakenly believe that this god will be a better ruler for the men of Ravenna than any would-be mortal kings. Little do they know their plan would bring the final destruction to Ravenna, if not civilization itself.

